The Architecture of Lack: Longing, Manifestation and Rest in Genesis 1–2 and Beyond

A comparative hermeneutic study of divine and human loneliness, developed from a Malayalam essay on the absence of loneliness in the complete human being

Abstract

This article proposes a reading of Genesis 1–2, continued through the New Testament, in which loneliness is the structure of felt absence and creation is the process by which that absence is filled. It makes eight connected claims. (1) The two divine designations of the opening chapters refer to two levels: *Elohim*, the Creator, who has self-identity but no name because no one yet exists to call it by one, and *Yahweh Elohim*, a limited, named presentation of that Creator, comparable to consciousness reflected over matter (*antaḥkaraṇa-pratibimbita-caitanya*). (2) The "darkness over the deep" (Gen 1:2) is a real lack in Elohim, experienced as not-seeing, and the longing is that felt absence itself. (3) Depth implies distance from an observer, so the vision of darkness is where the narrative's point of view begins. (4) Light needs darkness, and "good" means a lack filled. (5) Light and darkness are not cancelled but held in duality, because only manifestation gives the unmanifest meaning; the seventh-day rest is the peace of fulfilment, not the end of difference. (6) The human of Genesis 1:27 is complete, body and breath, male and female together; Yahweh sees this being as alone and separates the breath from it as Ḥawwāh (Eve, "mother of all living"), producing the *puruṣa–jīva* pair. (7) Genesis 2:4 through Revelation unfolds the six days at a limited, historical level, whose sixth day closes in the Passion and whose rest remains open (Heb 4). (8) The tensions between the biblical accounts act as a sieve that asks the reader to discriminate grain from chaff. The article sets these claims beside historical-critical exegesis, Indian philosophy, attachment theory and loneliness research, marks which claims are textual, comparative or constructive, and states what further work they require.

Keywords: loneliness; longing; Genesis 1–2; Elohim and Yahweh; *pratibimba*; manifestation; Sabbath; *puruṣa* and *jīva*; Tree of Life; hermeneutics

The argument in plain words

Imagine a story that begins in darkness. Something exists, but it cannot see itself, and it feels that something is missing. That feeling of missing something is the first longing. Then light appears, and the one who was longing sees that it is good, because the missing thing

has been found. The darkness is not thrown away. Light and dark are kept side by side, because things only mean something when they stand out against something else. After six days of making, everything is in place and visible, and the Creator rests in peace.

The story is told twice. The first time, in Genesis 1, it is told from far above, and the Creator speaks the world into being. The second time, from Genesis 2 onward, it is told close up, and the Creator is more like a gardener who forms a person from soil, breathes into him, and then notices that he is alone. In this telling the person is whole, with body and breath together. In a deep sleep the breath is taken out and given a form of its own, and that is Eve, whose name means "life". Two came out of one. That is how relationship begins, and also how longing begins among humans.

The story keeps going through the Bible. The sixth day finds its close at the cross, and the seventh day, the rest, is still open at the end of the book. Along the way the Bible tells some things in two slightly different ways, and the article suggests this is on purpose: it makes the reader choose what to keep and what to let go, as a farmer separates grain from husk.

How to read this article

The article is written in three layers, so that you can read as little or as much as you want.

1. **Plain words.** Each section opens with a short box in everyday language that says what the section claims.
2. **The main text.** The full argument, with the biblical, Indian and psychological material it uses.
3. **Going deeper.** At the end of the longer sections, a note gives the original words, the competing readings and the scholarly background, for readers who want to check or push further.

Unfamiliar terms are explained in the glossary near the end. You can read only the plain-words boxes and get the argument in about ten minutes.

1. Introduction

> **In plain words.** The article asks a simple question: when someone feels lonely, what exactly is missing, who notices it first, and what fixes it? Read closely, the Bible's first chapters suggest that the feeling of being alone is noticed by God before it is felt by the human being, and that this pattern shapes the whole story.

1.1 The problem

The essay from which this article grows opens with a paradox: there is no loneliness in a being that possesses humanness. It does not deny that human beings feel lonely. It claims that loneliness is a symptom of something missing in the structure of the person, so that a person who is whole in the relevant sense would not feel it. Three questions follow. When loneliness appears, what is missing? Who first perceives the lack? And what is the remedy?

The usual reading of Genesis 2:18 takes "it is not good that the man should be alone" as an observation about the human need for company, with the woman as the answer to a need the man feels. This article reverses the emphasis. The man never asks for a partner; he speaks for the first time in 2:23, to greet her. The perception of aloneness belongs to Yahweh God. Following that observation through the text leads to a larger claim: that lack, longing and fulfilment form the grammar of the whole creation narrative, and that the grammar begins in the Creator before it appears in the creature.

1.2 Status of the claims

The thesis mixes exegesis, comparative philosophy and constructive theology, and a reader should be able to tell which is which. Four labels are used throughout. **Textual** means observable in the Hebrew or Greek text. **Comparative** means supported by parallels in other traditions but not demonstrated by the text alone. **Constructive** means a proposal that is defensible and coherent but not demonstrable. **Speculative** means interesting but resting on little evidence.

Claim	Sections	Status
Elohim and Yahweh Elohim mark two levels: the Creator and its named, limited presentation	3	Textual pattern; level-reading is comparative
The darkness of Gen 1:2 is a real lack in the Creator	4	Constructive, with Upanishadic and Platonic parallels
Longing is the felt absence itself; depth implies an observer	4	Constructive
"Good" means a lack filled; light depends on darkness	5	Textual in part, constructive in part
Duality is preserved; the Sabbath is fulfilment, not cancellation	6	Constructive, with Kashmir Shaiva and Hegelian parallels
The first human is complete; the breath is later separated as Ḥawwāh	7	Constructive, supported by rabbinic and Upanishadic parallels

Claim	Sections	Status
Gen 2:4–Revelation unfolds the six days at a limited level	9	Constructive, with New Testament typology
The doubling of the accounts works as a sieve for the reader	10	Constructive
Monotheism supports integrated identity; death as numbness	8, 11	Mixed; partly speculative

1.3 Scope and cautions

This is comparative hermeneutics. It does not claim that the biblical authors intended Indian categories, and it does not claim that the narrative describes physical processes. Where the source essay uses the vocabulary of physics or genetics, this article treats the language as analogy and says so (Sections 4.3 and 11).

2. Method

> **In plain words.** Each passage is read on three levels: what the original words say, what other traditions help us see in it, and what psychology says about real people. The article also says plainly when a point is evidence and when it is an interpretation.

2.1 Layered reading

The study reads in three layers and keeps them apart so that a reader can accept one without the others. The philological layer asks what the Hebrew and Greek say and how scholars have read it. The comparative layer sets the text beside concepts from Indian philosophy, rabbinic interpretation and Western thought. The empirical layer compares claims about loneliness, protection and numbness with research in psychology.

2.2 *Adhyāropa–apavāda*

The Advaita method of *adhyāropa* (provisional superimposition) and *apavāda* (retraction) serves as a discipline of reading. The text first attributes human categories to God: seeing, judging, willing, resting, regretting. The retraction step asks what those categories disclose once the anthropomorphism is withdrawn. Divine "loneliness" is therefore read as a real structural claim about the origin, stated in the only vocabulary a human narrator has.

2.3 Etymology and wordplay

Several arguments rest on Sanskrit and Malayalam word-play. Two things are kept distinct: historical etymology, which traces how a word actually arose, and *nirukti*-style or homiletic etymology, which draws out meaning from resemblance of sound. The second is a respected genre in Indian and rabbinic exegesis and often yields real insight, but it is not historical evidence. Each etymology below is labelled.

2.4 Relation to historical criticism

Historical-critical scholarship attributes the use of *Elohim* in Genesis 1 largely to the Priestly source and the use of *Yahweh Elohim* in Genesis 2–3 largely to the Yahwist. This article does not dispute the compositional history. It asks a canonical question: whatever the history, what does the final text mean by keeping both voices side by side, and what happens if the reader treats the difference as meaningful?

3. Two Names, Two Levels

> **In plain words.** The Bible speaks of God in two ways at the start. Genesis 1 uses a title, *Elohim*, and God speaks the world into being. Genesis 2 uses a name, *Yahweh*, and God works like a potter and a gardener. This article reads these as one God at two levels: the Creator, who has no name because no one yet exists to say it, and a named, limited form through which the Creator can speak with human beings.

3.1 What the text shows

Genesis 1:1–2:3 uses only *Elohim*, a title that is grammatically plural and takes singular verbs. This God speaks, and things come to be. From Genesis 2:4 the narrator uses the compound *Yahweh Elohim*, and the acts change: this God forms, breathes, plants, walks, questions, clothes and closes. Four further features of the text bear on the distinction.

- In the dialogue of Genesis 3:1–5 the serpent and the woman say only *Elohim*; the compound belongs to the narrator's voice.
- Genesis 4:26 reports that in the days of Enosh people "began to call on the name of Yahweh". The name appears when there are people to call it.
- Exodus 6:3 has God say that he appeared to the patriarchs as *El Shaddai* and did not make himself known to them by the name Yahweh. The text itself distinguishes ways of being known.
- In the flood narrative it is Yahweh who regrets and is grieved in his heart (6:6) and who smells the pleasing aroma (8:21), while Elohim announces the end of all flesh in a more sovereign tone (6:13).

3.2 Elohim: the Creator, self-identified and unnamed

On the reading proposed here, Elohim is the Creator. It has self-identification but no name, because a name exists only for those who call, and in the beginning there is no one to call. It is above all creation and cannot be limited to a name. Exodus 3:14, "I am who I am" or "I will be what I will be", fits this: it is a self-designation that declines to function as a label. Elohim is *not* here identified with the non-dual absolute of Advaita. The Creator has a self that sees, and, as Section 4 argues, a lack that it perceives.

3.3 Yahweh: a named, limited presentation

Yahweh is a version of Elohim given limits of name and form so that the Creator can be communicated to human beings. The Advaita formulation of the *jīva*, "consciousness reflected in the inner instrument" (*antaḥkaraṇa-pratibimbita-caitanyaṃ jīvaḥ*), supplies the model. A reflection is the same consciousness as its source, but it appears limited by the surface that receives it. Here the surface is the soil (*adamah*) from which the human is formed, and the reflected agent is the one who forms, breathes and plants. The reflection school (*pratibimbavāda*, associated with the Vivaṇa tradition and the *Pañcadaśī*) uses this language for the *jīva*; the article applies it by analogy to the narrative agent.

A reflection inherits the limits of its medium: it is bounded, it says "I" and "mine", it needs a body, and it feels lack. Yahweh's regret, grief, planning and aloneness are therefore not defects of the Creator but marks of the presentation.

3.4 Accommodation

The idea that scripture describes God in a form suited to human understanding has a long history. The rabbinic principle that the Torah speaks in human language, Maimonides' account of anthropomorphic descriptions in *Guide* I.26, and Calvin's doctrine of divine accommodation (*Institutes* I.xiii.1) all treat such descriptions as concessions. The thesis differs in locating the limitation in name and form themselves, and in connecting it with a reflection model of the *jīva*.

3.5 What the distinction is not

The distinction does not posit two gods. Genesis 2:4 joins the names in a single phrase, and the canonical text presents one subject. It is also not a distinction between a "universal" and a "particular" mode of the same divine nature, as it might be put using *samaṣṭi* and *vyaṣṭi*; that language suggests two aspects of equal standing, whereas the reading proposed here is of an unlimited Creator and its limited presentation. The reading is a hermeneutic against the grain of the grammar, and it should be labelled as such.

Going deeper: the two designations.

- *Elohim* is the plural form of *eloah*, and in Genesis 1 it takes singular verbs, for example *bara* ("created"). *Yahweh* is written with four consonants (YHWH), probably from the root *hwh/hyh*, "to be"; Jewish practice reads *Adonai* in its place, and the Septuagint renders it *Kyrios*, "Lord".
- The source-critical reading, associated with Wellhausen and later scholars, assigns Genesis 1 largely to the Priestly writer and Genesis 2–3 largely to the Yahwist. The canonical reading in this article accepts that history and asks what the joined text means.
- Advaita Vedānta has two schools on how the one consciousness appears in many. The reflection school (*pratibimbavāda*) says the *jīva* is consciousness reflected in the mind; the delimitation school (*avacchedavāda*) says it is consciousness limited by the mind. Different traditions also treat *Īśvara*, the Lord, as consciousness reflected in the cosmic principle (*māyā*) and the *jīva* as reflected in the individual mind. The article borrows the reflection image as an analogy and does not claim the biblical text uses it.
- Objection to expect: Genesis 2:4 gives one phrase, *Yahweh Elohim*, as a single subject. The two-level reading is a reading against the surface of the grammar and should be argued as one.

4. The Darkness: Longing as Felt Absence

> **In plain words.** Before anything is made there is darkness over deep water. The article reads this as the Creator's own sense that something is missing, and that sense of missing is itself the longing. To feel that something is missing is already the first step toward finding it.

4.1 A lack in the Creator

The thesis holds that Elohim began creation to fill an absence in itself. The absence was its own incompleteness, and Elohim saw it as darkness. The darkness of Genesis 1:2 is therefore not a neutral setting; it is the Creator's own not-seeing, a self-ignorance (*ajñāna*, better rendered "concealment" than "stupidity"). Creation is then the Creator coming to see what it was.

This runs against classical theism, in which God is self-sufficient and without lack. It has a number of precedents elsewhere.

- *Bṛhadāraṇyaka Upaniṣad* 1.4.1–3 describes the Self alone at the beginning, afraid and without delight, wishing for a second. It then divides itself into two parts, husband and wife. The passage anticipates both the claim of lack and the separation of the woman discussed in Section 7.

- *Ṛigveda* 10.129 makes desire (*kāma*) the first seed of mind, and closes by wondering whether the one who surveys all from the highest heaven knows or does not know.
- Plato's *Symposium* has Diotima describe Eros as the child of Poros (resource) and Penia (poverty), and Aristophanes tell of double beings split in two, each half seeking the other.
- Process theology holds that God needs a world to be complete, and the "hidden treasure" tradition in Ibn ʿArabī's school speaks of a divine wish to be known.

The thesis therefore stands in an old line but must state its cost openly: it requires a notion of divine completeness in which fulfilment comes through manifestation.

4.2 Depth, distance and the observer

A "deep" is only deep for someone at a distance from it. Genesis 1:2 speaks of darkness on the *face* (*penê*) of the deep, and a face is a surface seen from outside and above, where the Spirit hovers. The verse is built around a point of view that looks down on something it is not part of. The distance between seer and seen is the first separation, a seer and a seen, which is the beginning of duality.

The narrative also has a narrator. No one witnessed the origin, so the account is a vision, a retrospective, told from a position. The thesis reads the narrator as the author or agent who visualises creation and puts the process into words. The vision of darkness is where that point of view begins.

4.3 Longing as the structure of absence

The central proposal of this section is that the longing is not a separate response to the darkness. Depth is distance; darkness is the inability to grasp or sense anything; together they make a felt absence, a sense of nothingness, deficiency or void. That felt absence pulls. The pull, which the essay calls a "negative pressure" defining the darkness, *is* the longing. There is no step at which a feeling arises and then prompts action. The structure of absence already tends toward fulfilment, and the movement of the Spirit and "Let there be light" are what that tendency does.

The essay identifies this negative pressure with gravity, the curvature of space-time. This article keeps the structural insight and treats the physical identification as an analogy. In physics a void does not pull by itself; differences of pressure do. Longing has the same form: it is a gradient, the gap between what is and what could be. Whether physical gravity is literally this longing is a metaphysical claim that this article neither affirms nor tests.

The same structure of felt lack as the seed of desire is found in Plato's *Eros* of poverty and resource, in Buddhist *taṇhā* (craving), and in modern accounts of desire as grounded in lack, such as Sartre's and Lacan's.

4.4 The hovering Spirit

The verb *meraḥefet* ("hovering", "fluttering") is used in Deuteronomy 32:11 of an eagle over its young, and *ruḥ* means wind, breath or spirit. Some scholars take *ruḥ Elohim* as "a mighty wind", others as a brooding spirit. On the reading proposed here the Spirit's hovering is the longing in motion. It is the stirring that precedes the word, and it comes first in the order because the impulse must precede the act. Nothing is yet made, but the stillness has been broken.

4.5 Whose vision?

If the vision of darkness is the narrator's, the lack it discloses might be the narrator's own human sense of lack, read back onto the origin. The thesis claims it is a real lack in Elohim. The route that makes this defensible is the doctrine of the divine image (Gen 1:26–27): the human sees the origin by looking within, because he is made in that image. The thesis should state this route openly, since the whole argument depends on it, and since a reader who denies the image-route will take the divine loneliness to be projection.

Going deeper: the opening verses.

- *Tōhû wābōhû* ("formless and empty") and *ḥōšek* ("darkness") describe the state before ordering. *Tĕhôm*, "the deep", is related in form to the Akkadian *Tiamat*, the primordial sea in Babylonian myth; scholars disagree about whether this means direct borrowing, and many hold that the words are only cognate. In Genesis the deep is not a rival deity but material.
- *Rûaḥ ʾĕlōhîm* can be rendered "the Spirit of God", "a wind of God" or "a mighty wind". The translation chosen does not change the argument that something stirs before the word is spoken, but it changes how personal the stirring sounds.
- In the Rigveda hymn 10.129, desire (*kāma*) is called the first seed of mind (verse 4). The hymn ends (verse 7) by asking whether the one who watches from the highest heaven knows, "or perhaps he does not know". It is a notable parallel for a creation that begins with an observer's uncertainty.
- A careful reviewer will ask: does the text describe a *lack* in God, or only a state before order? The article's answer rests on the divine-image argument in 4.5.

5. Light, Water and the Meaning of "Good"

> **In plain words.** Light is the answer to the darkness. We only know light because we know dark, so the darkness helps make light possible. When God calls the light "good", the word means that what was missing has been found.

5.1 Darkness as the precondition of light

Genesis 1:2 has darkness already there, and 1:3 does not say it was created. God separates light from darkness (1:4) and gives the darkness a name, Night. Isaiah 45:7, where God says he forms light and *creates* darkness, shows that the Bible knows another view; Genesis 1 presents darkness as prior. Light is defined against darkness. It is meant to remove it, and it can only be recognised as light, and as good, by contrast. The Creator therefore makes use of darkness, indirectly, in making light. This matches the Advaita structure in which knowledge (*jñāna*) takes ignorance (*ajñāna*) as its object and removes it, and so cannot appear without it.

5.2 Water

The thesis adds that primal matter, the water, is also used. The text does not say that light comes from the water: it comes by speech. The weaker form of the claim is that the water is the medium in which the light first becomes visible, and that what was hidden in the water is disclosed. The stronger form, that light is made out of water with darkness as its condition, is the author's inference, and it should be presented as such. There are parallels: the Rigvedic hymn 10.129 speaks of an undifferentiated water, and Agni is called *Apāṃ Napāt*, "son of the waters" (RV 2.35). The article adopts the weaker formulation as its default and records the stronger one as a proposal.

Water is also the standard medium in which light shows itself as a reflection. That connects the opening verses with the reflection model of Section 3.3: light on water is an image of consciousness on matter.

5.3 *Vellam*, *velicham*, *velutha*

In Malayalam the words for water (*veḷḷam*), light (*veḷiccam*) and white (*veḷutta*) resemble one another. They appear to share the Dravidian root *veḷ-*, "white, bright, clear", though the link of *veḷḷam* to that root should be confirmed in Burrow and Emeneau's *Dravidian Etymological Dictionary*. If confirmed, the resemblance is not accidental, and it points to a shared field of meaning in which clear water, clear light and whiteness belong together. It cannot bear any weight for the Hebrew text, where *mayim* and *ʾôr* are unrelated. It supports a Malayalam-language reading and the conceptual point that clarity lets things be seen.

5.4 "Good" as a filled lack

Light is the first thing called good (1:4). On the reading proposed here it is good because the longing has met its answer. This gives the word a precise sense that fits the rest of the book: "good" means a lack filled, and "not good" (2:18) is the one place where a lack stands unfilled. The values in the text are therefore these:

Text	State	Meaning
Darkness over the deep (1:2)	Felt absence	Longing
"Good" (1:4, 1:10 and so on)	Lack met	Fulfilment in part
"Not good" (2:18)	Lack open	Longing at the limited level
"Very good" (1:31)	All manifest	Fulfilment of the whole

5.5 Separation, not annihilation

Light and darkness "neutralise" each other only in the sense that the longing is met. God does not remove the darkness; he separates it from the light and names it Night, and each day ends with "there was evening and there was morning". The contrast is kept. The next section argues that this is the point.

Going deeper: light, water and the Hebrew text.

- Genesis 1:3 has light on the first day, but the sun, moon and stars (*mĕʾōrōt*, "light-bearers") come on the fourth day (1:14–19). Light is therefore not the same as the heavenly bodies. A rabbinic reading in *Genesis Rabbah* (3:4, to be verified) pictures God wrapped in light as in a garment, drawing on Psalm 104:2.
- Isaiah 45:7 says God forms light and creates (*bōrēʾ*) darkness. Genesis 1 does not use *bara* of the darkness, which is why the article calls it prior.
- In the Rigveda, Agni is *Apāṃ Napāt*, "son of the waters" (2.35), which shows fire or light associated with water in another tradition. This is a parallel and not evidence for the Hebrew text.
- The Dravidian root *veḷ-* is the basis of the Malayalam observation about *vellam*, *velicham* and *velutha*. The step that needs checking is whether *veḷḷam* belongs to the same root. Whatever is found, it supports a reading in Malayalam and not in Hebrew.

6. Manifestation and Rest

> **In plain words.** Light does not destroy darkness. The two are separated and kept, because things only mean something by contrast. By the sixth day everything is visible and in its place, and God rests. The rest is the peace of something complete, not the end of difference.

6.1 Why the unmanifest is meaningless

The thesis holds that differentiation is kept as duality so that the whole can be seen with its diversity and contrast, and that only then does everything become meaningful. In darkness everything is unmanifest, and the unmanifest is without meaning; after the sixth day everything is manifest and the longing is fulfilled.

This is the structure of several well-known positions. In the Kashmir Shaiva tradition of Abhinavagupta and Utpaladeva, manifestation (*ābhāsa*) is the real play of consciousness whose purpose is recognition (*pratyabhijñā*), not dissolution; it fits the earlier appeal to freedom (*svātantrya*) in the sense of spontaneous self-expression. In Hegel, spirit comes to know itself only through otherness. In Saussure, meaning in language arises from differences between terms. The Kabbalistic picture of the Infinite becoming known through its manifest forms belongs to the same family.

6.2 The sixth day and "very good"

On the sixth day the human is made in the divine image (1:26–27), and the verdict becomes "very good" (*ṭôb mĕʿōd*, 1:31), the only intensified verdict in the chapter. The human is the last creature made and the only one in the image, the point at which self-disclosure acquires a counterpart able to recognise it.

6.3 The seventh day: rest in peace

On the seventh day God rested (*wayyišbōt*, 2:2), and on this reading the rest follows fulfilment: what was longed for has been manifested. Several features support this.

- The Masoretic Text says God finished his work on the seventh day, whereas the Septuagint, the Samaritan Pentateuch and the Syriac read the sixth. The Masoretic reading makes the rest the completing act. Rashi, drawing on *Genesis Rabbah*, asks what the world still lacked and answers: rest (*menuḥah*).
- Exodus 31:17 says God rested and "was refreshed" (*wayyinnāpaš*, from *nepeš*, "self" or "life"), the language of a self restored.
- Unlike the previous six days, the seventh has no refrain of "evening and morning". On a reading in which duality is kept, this means that striving ends while contrast stays. The cycle of lack met and reopened gives way to peace.

The text says that God rested from his work and not that he rested because a longing was satisfied. The connection to longing is an inference, made at the *adhyāropa* stage, and it should be labelled as such. The verdict "very good" is pronounced on everything made, so the rest may mark the completion of the whole and not only of the human.

6.4 The cost of the position

If the unmanifest is meaningless without manifestation, then Elohim needs creation for its own fulfilment. That sits with the claim that creation began from lack, but it conflicts with the common view that creation is a free act done without need. Two replies are open. The first accepts the consequence and calls creation necessary for the Creator. The second draws on the Kashmir Shaiva idea that manifestation is the spontaneous expression of freedom, a necessity of nature that is also free. The thesis leans toward the first and should say that the second is available as a refinement. The question remains open and should be argued, not assumed.

Going deeper: the vocabulary of rest.

- Three verbs are used of God's rest. In Genesis 2:2–3 it is *šābat*, "to cease". In Exodus 20:11 it is *wayyānaḥ*, "he rested". In Exodus 31:17 it is *šābat wayyinnāpaš*, "he ceased and was refreshed". The last uses *nepeš*, the word for self or life, which is what makes the argument for a restored self.
- Genesis 2:2 reads, in the Masoretic Text, that God "finished" (*wayĕkal*) on the seventh day. The Septuagint, the Samaritan Pentateuch and the Syriac read "the sixth". Both readings are old, and the article's argument works on either, though it is stronger on the Masoretic.
- In the Kashmir Shaiva school, Abhinavagupta and his teacher's teacher Utpaladeva hold that consciousness is free (*svātantrya*) and that the world is its real self-display (*ābhāsa*), recognised again by the knower (*pratyabhijñā*, "recognition"). This is quite different from Śaṅkara's Advaita, in which the world is ultimately an appearance, and the contrast is worth stating if the article is submitted to Indologists.
- The question of whether creation is necessary or free is an old one in philosophical theology and was discussed in medieval Jewish, Christian and Islamic thought.

7. The Complete Human and the Separation

> **In plain words.** The first human is whole: body and breath, male and female together. God, in the limited form of Yahweh, looks at him and sees someone alone. In a deep sleep the breath is taken out and given its own form as Eve, whose name means "life". Two came out of one, and that is how relationship, love and longing enter human life.

7.1 A being complete in body and breath

The thesis holds that the human was complete before Yahweh separated Ḥawwāh from him. Two textual elements make the point. Genesis 1:27 creates the human as male and female together, so that in the first account the human holds both principles in one being.

Genesis 2:7 forms the human from the soil and breathes the breath of life into the nostrils, so that the human becomes a living being (*nepeš ḥayyâ*): body from the earth and breath from God. A body with its breath is the whole of a living person.

There are parallels for an original being that holds both principles. Rabbinic tradition (*Genesis Rabbah* 8) records the reading that the first human was a double being, later divided, and it reads *ṣēlāʿ* in 2:21 as "side" as well as "rib". The *Bṛhadāraṇyaka* passage cited above says the Self was as large as a man and woman in embrace before it divided into two. Aristophanes' myth in the *Symposium* has the same shape.

7.2 "It is not good" is Yahweh's perception

The verse "it is not good that the man should be alone" (2:18) reports Yahweh's evaluation, not the man's complaint. The text bears this out: the man says nothing until 2:23. On the reading proposed here the man is not lacking anything. Yahweh, the limited and embodied presentation of the Creator, sees a being that appears alone and feels, in its own person, the lack that Section 4 traced to the beginning. Loneliness has moved from the Creator to the presentation, and the man is the occasion.

The reading adopted here is that the man is complete, that the need is Yahweh's, and that the animals fail as helpers because the man is not lacking what they could supply. The Hebrew *ʿēzer kĕnegdô* ("a helper corresponding to him", 2:18) names what Yahweh seeks: a counterpart, a second, and not a servant.

7.3 The order of creation: manifestation and need

Genesis 1 and Genesis 2 make the human at different points. In Genesis 1 the human is last, as the completion of the sequence. In Genesis 2 the human is first (2:7), and the animals come afterwards (2:19) as attempts to answer the "not good". The two orders follow two motives. Genesis 1 gives the order of manifestation, and Genesis 2 gives the order of need. This is what one expects if Genesis 2 retells the process at a limited level, driven by the lack that the limited agent feels.

The naming of the animals (2:19–20) is an exercise of discrimination. The man names each creature and so recognises it as other, and finds that none is like himself. Naming in the ancient Near East is defining and classifying. The "not found" of 2:20 marks the limit of classification: what lies beyond it is not another thing but another self.

7.4 The deep sleep

The Hebrew *tardēmāh* (2:21) denotes a deep sleep sent by God, in which the sleeper is passive. The *Māṇḍūkya Upaniṣad* describes three states of experience, waking (*jāgrat*), dream (*svapna*) and deep sleep (*suṣupti*), with a fourth (*turīya*) beyond them. In *suṣupti* the sense of a separate self recedes and there is no duality; it is felt as security. Security

is lost in dream and waking because in those states the mind makes fine distinctions that are unclear and produce uncertainty. The separation takes place in the state in which the man is undivided and secure, and he is unaware of it. What he later recognises ("bone of my bones and flesh of my flesh") is known only on waking.

7.5 The separation of the breath

The thesis holds that what was given as breath to the earthly form was later taken and kept separate. This is Ḥawwāh, whose name the text explains from *ḥay*, "living", and glosses as "mother of all living" (3:20). The reading of her as the "source of life" is therefore well grounded in the text's own explanation of the name. The separation divides a complete person into two principles.

Principle	Genesis figure	Indian category	Function
Personal centre	The man	*Puruṣa*; the body-person (*jaḍa*)	Identity, continuity
Animating life	The woman, Ḥawwāh	*Jīva*, *prāṇa*, *śakti*	Movement, vitality
Embodied union	"One flesh" (2:24)	*Śarīra* as *dehī*	The living person

The gloss of *puruṣa* as the one who lies in the city (*puri śete*, the body) is the traditional Upaniṣadic derivation and is well founded. The body persists as a distinct, living whole only when both principles are united; when they separate, it loses both identity and vitality. "One flesh" is the attempt at restoration.

The separation has two aspects that the thesis should keep together. It is the entry of duality at the limited level, which Section 6 argued is the condition for meaning, and so it makes relationship, love and renewal possible. It is also the cause of a lack that the man and the woman did not have before: nakedness (weakness), shame, curiosity, fear and the cycle of death and renewal. The first aspect is the gain and the second the price. The thesis has not yet decided which is primary, and a mature version should say so.

7.6 *Tuṇa*: help, company, protection, guard

The Malayalam word *tuṇa* carries the senses help, company, protection and guard. The woman's function, on this reading, is to protect the seat of feeling. Genesis 2:21–22 builds her from bone and flesh of the man's side, and the essay reads this material as the protective shell of the heart. The anatomical link is the essay's own and is not in the text, but it is a fruitful symbol: if "to protect" is the central sense of *tuṇa*, the choice of material from the chest has an intelligible meaning.

Going deeper: the first human and the woman.

- *Ādām* is a collective noun here, "the human", formed from *ʾădāmâ*, "soil", in a wordplay. The word *ʾîš* ("man") first appears in 2:23, after the woman exists, as the man names her *ʾiššâ*. Before that moment the figure is *hāʾādām*, "the human". This supports the point that the sexes are distinguished by the separation.
- *ʿēzer kĕnegdô* is often translated "helper". *ʿĒzer* is used of God as helper in several psalms (for example 33:20) and carries no sense of inferiority. *Kĕnegdô* means roughly "corresponding to him", "facing him".
- *Ḥawwâ* is connected in 3:20 to *ḥay*, "living". The Septuagint renders the name *Zōē*, "Life" (in one place).
- *Genesis Rabbah* 8:1 records the view that the first human was an *androgynos*, a double being. The *Bṛhadāraṇyaka* Upaniṣad (1.4.3) says the Self divided itself into two, husband and wife. Aristophanes' speech in Plato's *Symposium* (189c–193d) gives a version with round double beings split by Zeus.
- Sāṃkhya philosophy pairs *puruṣa* (the conscious witness) with *prakṛti* (nature). The article pairs *puruṣa* with *jīva* (life) instead, which is not the Sāṃkhya pairing, and should say so if it addresses Indologists.
- Objection to expect: Genesis 2 does not say the breath was *taken out* and made into the woman; it says a *ṣēlāʿ* was taken. The article's reading of the breath is an interpretation joining 2:7, 2:21–22 and 3:20.

8. Loneliness Reconsidered: Protection, Attachment and Numbness

> **In plain words.** Loneliness is better understood as feeling unprotected than as simply lacking company. A child with a caring adult is not lonely. Research on attachment and on the health effects of loneliness points the same way. The section also looks at the idea that neglect makes us numb, and that numbness feels like dying.

8.1 Loneliness as felt absence of protection

The essay defines the root of loneliness as the feeling of not being protected, and illustrates it with a child accompanied by a guardian, who feels no loneliness and has no fear of it. This is distinctive. Loneliness is usually defined as the gap between desired and actual social relationships. Here the emphasis falls on safety, so that a person surrounded by threatening people is lonely in the sense that matters, and a person alone but secure is not.

This resembles the central claim of attachment theory (Bowlby, Ainsworth): a caregiver is a secure base from which the infant explores and a safe haven to which it returns, and separation distress is the response to loss of protection. Paul Tillich's distinction between the pain of being alone and the glory of being alone points the same way, since aloneness is not itself a harm. Empirical work by Cacioppo and colleagues describes loneliness as perceived social isolation tied to heightened vigilance for social threat, and a meta-analysis by Holt-Lunstad, Smith and Layton (2010) links weak social relationships to substantially increased mortality risk. The research supports the view that loneliness is a state of perceived insecurity with real physiological consequences.

The relation is one of consonance and not proof. The literature concerns human social relationships and does not test claims about divine loneliness or the metaphysics of body and breath. Its use here is to show that the "not good" of 2:18 can be read as an ancient recognition of the harm of isolation.

8.2 Neglect, numbness and death

The essay proposes that the separation felt by humankind is a self-created distance, caused by repeated neglect. As a neglected limb becomes numb, so when life-sustaining practices are neglected, a bodily and mental numbness (*maravippu*) arises, and it is experienced as death (*maraṇam*). The numbness disappears when attention returns, so it is called a kind of illusion, and by extension death is called an illusion. Those who died by neglect are raised by attention.

The link between *maravippu* and *maraṇam* is paronomasia: the words share a sound, not an etymology. As homiletic wordplay it is effective, but resemblance of sound does not establish resemblance of reality. The idea behind it has substance when it is stated without the pun. Neglect of bodily and psychological needs produces measurable decline, and many forms of what is felt as dying while alive, such as withdrawal, apathy and affective numbing, can be reversed by care and attention. That is consistent with contemplative and therapeutic traditions that stress regular practice (*caryā*, *sādhana*). The stronger claim that biological death is an illusion belongs to metaphysics and theology and cannot be shown from observations about numbness.

The essay also describes a cycle in which deficiencies accumulate like waste, the body is abandoned, and desire leads to a new body until the deficiencies are made good. This is a rendering of rebirth (*saṃsāra*), and it belongs to the Indian doctrine and not the biblical one: the Hebrew Bible has no doctrine of reincarnation, and the New Testament speaks of resurrection. It should be presented as a comparative construction.

9. The Unfolding at the Limited Level: Genesis 2 to Revelation

> **In plain words.** The six days of Genesis 1 are told again, from a smaller and more human viewpoint, from Genesis 2 to the book of Revelation. The article suggests that the story's sixth day closes at the cross, and that its seventh day, the rest, is still open.

9.1 One process at two levels

The thesis holds that Genesis 2:4 through Revelation unfolds the six days of creation at a limited, objective level. Genesis 2:4 itself supports this: it speaks of the generations (*tōlĕdôt*) of the heavens and the earth and says Yahweh Elohim made earth and heavens "in the *day*", in the singular. The six days are compressed into one "day" and then unfold in time.

Feature	Genesis 1:1–2:3 (Elohim)	Genesis 2:4 to Revelation (Yahweh Elohim and the limited level)
Mode of action	Speech, sovereign	Forming, planting, walking, regretting
Order	The human is last	The human is first; animals are attempts
Time	Six days	One "day" unfolding as generations
Lack	Darkness over the deep	"Not good" to be alone
Fulfilment	Light, "good", "very good"	The woman, "one flesh", finally the Tree of Life
Rest	The seventh day, with no refrain of evening and morning	A Sabbath rest that "remains" (Heb 4:9); no night (Rev 22:5)

9.2 The doubling in the flood narrative

The flood account shows the two voices giving different instructions. In Genesis 6:19–20 (Elohim) Noah takes two of every kind. In 7:2–3 (Yahweh) he takes seven pairs of the clean animals and two of the unclean; the Hebrew "seven seven" can also mean seven individuals. Combined with the differences of tone in 6:6, 6:13 and 8:21, the thesis reads the pair as showing an identity conflict between the two presentations. Historical criticism explains the doubling by the weaving of two sources. The thesis accepts that and asks what it means that the final text kept both; the answer given in Section 10 is that the doubling works as a sieve.

9.3 The sixth day closes at the cross

The limited level's own sixth day closes, on this reading, in the Passion. Several features of the Gospel of John echo the creation account. Jesus dies on Friday, the sixth day, on which the man was made. His last words, "It is finished" (19:30), use a verb related to the one the Septuagint uses when God finished his work (Gen 2:2). He is buried in a garden (19:41), rests in the tomb through the Sabbath, and rises on "the first day of the week" (20:1), which reads as the first day of a new creation.

The essay calls Jesus the person who completed the process, and on this reading the limited level's sixth day closes in him, as the complete human. This fits the typology in which Christ is the last Adam (1 Cor 15:45) and the firstborn of creation (Col 1:15).

9.4 The seventh day remains open

Hebrews 4:3–10 quotes Genesis 2:2 and argues that a Sabbath rest *remains* for the people of God. God's rest comes first and a human entry into it comes later, which is a two-level structure inside the New Testament. John 5:17 points the same way: "My Father is working until now, and I am working." Work continues, so the rest has not yet been fully entered at the limited level.

Revelation is built on sevens, of seals, trumpets and bowls. The seventh seal brings silence (8:1), the seventh trumpet brings the kingdom (11:15), and the seventh bowl brings "It is done" (16:17); the words return in 21:6. The final chapter brings the river, the Tree of Life and "no more night" (22:1–5). The picture retains diversity, since the nations are healed by the tree's leaves (22:2); it is rest without loss of difference, as Section 6 argued. Some early writers, such as the *Epistle of Barnabas* and Irenaeus, read the six days as six ages and the seventh as the millennial reign of Revelation 20. This is an old tradition but not a firm exegetical result, and it is treated here as speculative.

The Tree of Life stands for the sum of the practices that sustain life. Humanity is barred from it in Genesis 3:22–24 and given access in Revelation 22, when, on the essay's reading, every neglect has been removed.

Going deeper: the structure of Genesis, the Gospel and Revelation.

- Genesis is organised by a formula, *ʾēlleh tôlĕdôt* ("these are the generations of"), which opens 2:4, 5:1, 6:9 and other sections. The 2:4 occurrence marks the turn from the cosmic account to the human one.
- The Gospel of John opens with "In the beginning" (1:1), has the garden in the arrest, burial and resurrection scenes (18:1; 19:41; 20:15), and places the resurrection on "the first day" (20:1). "It is finished" translates *tetelestai*, from *teleō*, the same family as the verb the Septuagint uses at Genesis 2:2 (*synetelesen*). The echoes are widely noticed, though scholars differ on how deliberate each one is.

- Hebrews 3:7–4:11 is a long argument from Psalm 95 and Genesis 2:2 that God's rest is still open to enter. Its word for the rest, *sabbatismos* (4:9), is a rare word.
- Revelation's sevens are sealed, trumpeted and poured out in sequence. The "It is done" at 16:17 and 21:6 is *gegonen / gegonan*.
- The millennial reading in the *Epistle of Barnabas* (15) and Irenaeus (*Against Heresies* V.28.3) takes Psalm 90:4 and 2 Peter 3:8 ("a day is as a thousand years") as a key. It is influential but speculative.
- On the flood, the Hebrew in 7:2 is *šib'â šib'â*, "seven seven".

10. The Text as Sieve: Grain, Chaff and the Reader

> **In plain words.** The Bible tells some stories in two slightly different ways. Instead of treating that as a flaw, the article suggests it makes readers choose what to keep and what to let go, as a farmer separates grain from husk. The test proposed is whether a reading leaves you steadier or more divided inside, with some safeguards added.

10.1 The proposal

The slight conflicts between the accounts are not flaws to be smoothed over. They work as a sieve. A reader must separate the grain (*nellu*) from the empty husk (*pathir*), and that takes the faculty that made the world in the story, discrimination (*viveka*). The text asks of its readers what God does in Genesis 1: separate light from darkness, good from not good. This extends the argument that creation proceeds by distinction.

The tradition offers parallels. In Matthew 13:24–30 wheat and weeds grow together until the harvest, and in Mark 4:11–12 Jesus speaks in parables so that those who look can understand. Proverbs 25:2 says it is the glory of God to conceal a matter and the glory of kings to search it out. Rabbinic tradition holds that the Torah has seventy faces, and Indian tradition prescribes a qualified reader (*adhikārī*) for the *śruti*. The historical-critical explanation, the weaving of two sources, speaks to origin. The claim that the conflicts *work* as a sieve holds whatever their origin; the claim that they were put there on purpose is harder to prove, and the thesis makes only the first.

10.2 The criterion

The author's test for separating grain from chaff is internal. The reader's own internal identity conflicts identify the chaff, and the reader's own internal stability identifies the grain. This is consistent with the thesis, in which identity conflict is the mark of a divided

personality and stability the mark of an integrated one. It has parallels in Ignatian discernment, in the place of experience (*anubhava*) among the sources of Advaita knowledge, and in Matthew 7:16 ("by their fruits").

10.3 Limits of the criterion

Inner stability has several sources, and not all track truth. A rigid belief system or closed group can give a very stable sense of self. Discomfort can signal growth, and in the Socratic tradition the unease of *aporia* comes before understanding. A reader can mistake familiarity for truth, so that what confirms prior belief feels like stability. A test of "does this unsettle me?" alone would favour whatever is comfortable.

A stronger form keeps the criterion and adds conditions: the stability should survive challenge and not only absence of challenge; it should be compatible with coherence across the text and with its effects on other people, for which the essay's own measure, practices that sustain life, is a natural fit; and it should be judged over time and not at a single moment. The criterion would then be one of three checks, close to the Advaita arrangement of scripture, reasoning and experience.

Going deeper: reading and discernment.

- The rabbinic saying that the Torah has "seventy faces" (the source is usually given as *Numbers Rabbah* 13:15, to be verified) and the fourfold medieval scheme *PaRDeS* (*peshat*, *remez*, *derash*, *sod*) both treat Scripture as having layers.
- Ignatius of Loyola's rules for discernment in the *Spiritual Exercises* distinguish consolation from desolation as a test of inner movements. His tradition adds that a consolation must be examined, because the evil spirit can also bring comfort.
- The Advaita arrangement of three sources of knowledge, *śruti* (scripture), *yukti* (reasoning) and *anubhava* (experience), is a model for a test that does not rest on experience alone.
- Psychology adds a caution. Research on confirmation bias and on motivated reasoning shows that people tend to feel more at ease with claims that match what they already believe, which is why an inner test needs outside checks.

11. Identity, Worship and Integration

> **In plain words.** The last claim is that having one steady source of identity supports a settled personality, while being pulled in many directions unsettles it. The article restates the original essay's language about genetics as a claim about psychology.

The essay ends with an argument about the ethical function of the ideas of one God, one first-born, one personality and self-realisation. These ideas, it holds, support unity of personality, self-confidence and freedom from servile attitudes, whereas worship of many gods, images or persons produces a divided personality, identity crisis and dependence. In the essay's words the instability is "genetic".

The language of genetics should be replaced. Nothing in current genetics supports a causal link between religious belief and genetic stability. What can be said is psychological: an integrated sense of identity, as in Erikson's account of identity formation, is associated with well-being, and dependence on external authorities can weaken self-efficacy. These are psychological claims and they hold across religious and non-religious contexts. In the thesis as now framed, the "one God" to whom the argument refers is Elohim, the unnamed Creator, and Yahweh is a presentation of that Creator; this affects how the argument is stated but not its direction.

The argument has precedent. The prophets criticised the worship of images as misplaced trust, and John 4:23–24 speaks of worship "in spirit and truth". It needs qualification: traditions with many deities, including strands of Hindu thought, have also developed refined accounts of the integrated self, and monotheistic communities have produced dependent and authoritarian attitudes. The most defensible form is conditional: whichever theology is held, worship that cultivates inner integration, responsibility and freedom serves the human good, and worship that fosters self-abdication does not.

12. Critical Evaluation

> **In plain words.** A fair look at what the argument does well, where it is weakest, and what work should come next.

12.1 Strengths

- It notices a real feature of the text, that the perception of aloneness is Yahweh's before it is the man's, and it follows the consequences.
- It gives "good" and "not good" a single meaning, a lack filled and a lack open, and so connects the first chapter with the second.
- It explains the different orders of creation in Genesis 1 and 2 by the difference of motive.
- It offers a vocabulary, from Indian philosophy, for the relation between person and life, and a reflection model for the two divine designations.
- Its definition of loneliness as absence of protection agrees with attachment research.

- It reads the doubling in the text as a sieve, and so turns an apparent defect into a feature that the thesis can use.

12.2 Weaknesses and open questions

- Several arguments rest on sound-based etymology, which cannot carry evidential weight.
- The claim of lack in the Creator conflicts with classical theism and depends on the divine-image route of Section 4.5.
- If creation fulfils a lack, it may not be free; Section 6.4 sets out two ways to answer and does not choose.
- The reading of Yahweh as a presentation of Elohim goes against the grammar of Genesis 2:4, where one subject is named.
- The relative weight of gain and loss in the separation of Ḥawwāh is undecided (Section 7.5).
- Physical and genetic terms in the essay are analogies at best.
- The claims about the uniqueness of Jesus and the illusory nature of death are theological commitments and not conclusions of the analysis.
- The criterion of inner stability needs the further conditions in Section 10.3.
- The link of rebirth to the biblical narrative is asserted and not argued.

12.3 Next steps

1. Argue the divine-image route in full, with attention to Genesis 1:26–27 and to the history of the doctrine.
2. Choose between the two replies of Section 6.4, or show that they converge.
3. Test the Dravidian etymology of *veḷ-* against the dictionary and state what it does and does not support.
4. Engage the scholarship on Genesis 2–3 and on Indian readings of Genesis directly, beyond the indicative references below.
5. Write the Passion-as-sixth-day argument in detail, with the Johannine scholarship.

13. Conclusion

> **In plain words.** A short summary of the whole argument, from the darkness at the start to the rest at the end.

The thesis offers a reading in which the Bible's first two chapters are a single movement with two voices. The Creator, unnamed and above creation, perceives its own absence as darkness; the perception is the longing; light answers it and is called good; the contrast between light and darkness is kept because only manifestation gives meaning; the sixth day completes the manifestation; and the Creator rests. At the limited level the same movement is told again by a named, embodied presentation, who sees the complete human as alone, separates the breath from him, and so brings duality, relationship and renewal into being at a price. The story runs on through the Gospel, where the sixth day closes in the Passion, and the rest remains open until the final chapter. The text's doubling asks its readers to discriminate, and the reader's own stability is the first test.

What the thesis claims for loneliness is modest and substantive. Loneliness is the felt absence of protection and wholeness; it begins before the creature; and it is met, at every level, by manifestation that holds difference and gives it meaning. The position does not depend on any single etymology or on the physical analogies of the source essay. It can be examined by readers from different traditions, and it opens a path for further work in comparative scriptural interpretation and the psychology of religion.

Glossary

- **Accommodation** — the idea that Scripture describes God in terms humans can grasp.
- **Adhyāropa-apavāda** — "superimposition and retraction": first describe the unknown in familiar terms, then take the description back to see what remains.
- **Ajñāna** — not-knowing; in this article, concealment or self-ignorance.
- **Antaḥkaraṇa** — the inner instrument, meaning the mind with its faculties.
- **Ābhāsa** — appearance or display; in Kashmir Shaivism, the real showing-forth of consciousness.
- **Elohim** — the Hebrew word for God used in Genesis 1; here, the Creator.
- **Ēzer kĕnegdô** — "a helper corresponding to him" (Gen 2:18).
- **Hermeneutics** — the study of how texts are interpreted.
- **Ḥawwâ** — Eve; the name is linked in the text to "living".
- **Jīva** — the living, individual self; in this article, also the life-breath.
- **Maravippu / maraṇam** — Malayalam for "numbness" and "death"; the article treats their resemblance as a pun, not an etymology.
- **Menuḥah** — rest, in the sense of settled peace.
- **Nellu and pathir** — Malayalam for grain and empty husk.
- **Nirukti** — a traditional way of explaining a word by what it sounds like.
- **Pratibimba** — reflection; **pratibimbavāda**, the school that explains the individual self as a reflection of consciousness.

- **Prāṇa** — life-breath.
- **Puruṣa** — the person or centre of a being; derived traditionally from *pura*, "city" (the body).
- **Rûaḥ** — Hebrew for wind, breath or spirit.
- **Saṃsāra** — the cycle of birth and death in Indian thought.
- **Suṣupti** — deep, dreamless sleep, the third of the three states in the Māṇḍūkya Upaniṣad.
- **Svātantrya** — freedom, in the sense of self-possession.
- **Tardēmāh** — a deep sleep sent by God (Gen 2:21).
- **Tĕhôm** — "the deep", the primal water of Genesis 1:2.
- **Toledot** — "generations", a formula that structures the book of Genesis.
- **Tuṇa** — Malayalam for help, company, protection and guard.
- **Viveka** — discrimination, the ability to tell one thing from another.
- **Yahweh** — the personal name of God in the Hebrew Bible, written YHWH; in this article, a limited, named presentation of the Creator.

References (indicative; verify editions and pagination before submission)

Biblical, rabbinic and philological

- Alter, R. (1996). *Genesis: Translation and Commentary*. W. W. Norton.
- Levenson, J. D. (1988). *Creation and the Persistence of Evil*. Harper & Row.
- Trible, P. (1978). *God and the Rhetoric of Sexuality*. Fortress Press.
- Wenham, G. J. (1987). *Genesis 1–15*. Word Biblical Commentary 1. Word Books.
- Westermann, C. (1984). *Genesis 1–11: A Commentary*. Augsburg.
- *Genesis Rabbah*; Rashi on Genesis 2:2.
- Maimonides. *The Guide of the Perplexed*, I.26.
- Calvin, J. *Institutes of the Christian Religion*, I.xiii.1.

New Testament and early Christian

- Attridge, H. W. (1989). *The Epistle to the Hebrews*. Hermeneia. Fortress Press.
- Brown, R. E. (1970). *The Gospel According to John (xiii–xxi)*. Anchor Bible 29A. Doubleday.
- *Epistle of Barnabas* 15; Irenaeus, *Against Heresies* V.28.3.

Indian philosophy and language

- Olivelle, P. (1998). *The Early Upaniṣads: Annotated Text and Translation*. Oxford University Press.
- Śaṅkara. *Commentary on the Māṇḍūkya Upaniṣad with Gauḍapāda's Kārikā*.
- Vidyāraṇya. *Pañcadaśī*.
- Torella, R. (2002). *The Īśvarapratyabhijñākārikā of Utpaladeva*. Motilal Banarsidass.
- Burrow, T., & Emeneau, M. B. (1984). *A Dravidian Etymological Dictionary* (2nd ed.). Clarendon Press.

Philosophy

- Plato. *Symposium* (189c–193d; 203b).
- Hegel, G. W. F. (1807). *Phenomenology of Spirit*.
- Saussure, F. de (1916). *Course in General Linguistics*.

Psychology and neuroscience

- Bowlby, J. (1969). *Attachment and Loss, Vol. 1: Attachment*. Basic Books.
- Ainsworth, M. D. S., Blehar, M. C., Waters, E., & Wall, S. (1978). *Patterns of Attachment*. Erlbaum.
- Cacioppo, J. T., & Patrick, W. (2008). *Loneliness: Human Nature and the Need for Social Connection*. W. W. Norton.
- Erikson, E. H. (1968). *Identity: Youth and Crisis*. W. W. Norton.
- Holt-Lunstad, J., Smith, T. B., & Layton, J. B. (2010). Social relationships and mortality risk: A meta-analytic review. *PLoS Medicine, 7*(7), e1000316.
- Tillich, P. (1963). *The Eternal Now*. Scribner.